

Leave Policy

Sample document for testing purposes

1 1. Purpose and Eligibility

This policy explains how employees request, record, and use approved time away from work. It applies to regular employees unless a contract, local law, or collective agreement provides a more favorable entitlement.

2 2. Types of Leave

The organization may provide the following categories, subject to eligibility rules:

- Annual or vacation leave for rest and personal activities.
- Sick leave for illness, injury, medical appointments, or recovery.
- Family or personal leave for qualifying family or personal needs.
- Parental, bereavement, civic, or other statutory leave where applicable.
- Unpaid leave when approved in advance and permitted by policy or law.

3 3. Requesting Leave

Employees should submit planned leave through the approved HR or scheduling system at least five working days before the first day away. The request should state the dates, expected return date, and a contact method when appropriate. Managers should respond promptly and consider staffing, business continuity, and fairness.

4 4. Short-Notice and Emergency Leave

When unexpected illness or an emergency prevents attendance, the employee must notify the manager as soon as reasonably possible, preferably before the scheduled start time. A coworker should not be asked to submit the notice on the employee's behalf except in an emergency.

5 5. Approval and Conflicts

Leave is not considered approved until the manager or designated system confirms it. Managers may suggest alternate dates when overlapping absences would create a significant operational risk. Approved leave should not be cancelled arbitrarily; any change must be discussed with the employee.

6 6. Documentation

Where permitted and necessary, the organization may request reasonable documentation for extended, recurring, or legally protected leave. Medical information must be handled confidentially and shared only with authorized personnel. Employees should not include diagnosis details in ordinary scheduling messages.

7 7. Return to Work

Employees are expected to return on the approved date or contact their manager before the leave expires if an extension is needed. Failure to return or communicate may be treated as an attendance concern, subject to applicable law and due process.

8 8. Non-Retaliation and Administration

No employee will be penalized for requesting or using leave lawfully. Human Resources owns this policy, maintains leave records, and resolves interpretation questions. This sample policy does not replace local legal requirements or an employment agreement.